



MSC World America — Family Edition

December 5 – 12, 2026 · Our family sailing

Ship: MSC World America · **Sailing from:** MSC Miami Cruise Terminal · **Cabins:** _____

A condensed Voyage Pack from [In the Wake](#) — the essentials in three pages. The full pack covers cabins, packing, budget, ship orientation, ports in depth, MSC's quirks, and the family rhythm.

Day by day

Times are the published schedule — **verify everything in the MSC for Me app**; they shift between sailings.

#	Date	Port	Hours ashore	Dock/Tender	The one thing
1	Sat Dec 5	PortMiami — embarkation	board 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM; depart ~4:30 PM	—	Register the kids at Doremiland on boarding. Sailaway at the World Promenade (Deck 8 aft).
2	Sun Dec 6	Cruising at sea	—	—	Settling-in day. Possible Gala Evening; specialty dining slots open.
3	Mon Dec 7	Roatán, Honduras	~9:00 AM – 6:00 PM	dock at Coxen Hole (Port of Roatán)	West Bay Beach + reef snorkel. December = rainy-season tail (rain 3 days in 4) — loose plan, dry bags.
4	Tue Dec 8	Costa Maya, Mexico	~8:00 AM – 5:00 PM	dock	Easiest family day: walk from ship to the free pool complex, or Chacchoben ruins (~\$50 indep).
5	Wed Dec 9	Cozumel, Mexico	~9:00 AM – 7:00 PM	dock (Punta Langosta, Intl, or Puerta Maya)	Chankanaab (~\$50) — calmest kid snorkel. Palancar for confident swimmers if no norther.
6	Thu Dec 10	Cruising at sea	—	—	Recovery day. Second Gala likely. Laundry round; book any Ocean Cay cabana tonight.
7	Fri Dec 11	Ocean Cay (Bahamas)	~7:00 AM – 6:00 PM (daytime call)	dock alongside	Seekers Family Cove first. Daytime call = lighthouse evening show likely does NOT run — verify.
8	Sat Dec 12	PortMiami — debarkation	off by 10:00 AM	—	Uber to MIA ~\$30–45. Home thirteen days before Christmas.

Possible Gala Evenings: typically the two sea-day evenings (Day 2 + Day 6). Smart-casual otherwise; **MSC's dress culture is European-casual**. One nicer outfit per kid covers both.

MSC for Me app is the operational hub — daily program, dining bookings, kids-club hours, account balance, deck plans. **Download and log in for the whole family before sailing.**

Currency aboard: USD. **Service Charge (gratuity):** \$17/day standard (\$23 Yacht Club) as of May 11, 2026; **child rates differ — verify the current schedule with MSC or your agent.**

December weather, in one line: Miami mild and dry (78/65) · Roatán warm and often wet (81/77) · Mexican ports warm with shower odds (81–82/74) · Ocean Cay pleasant Bahamian winter (76/72) — normals from the 2020–2024 archive; the real forecast lands in the companion PWA ~16 days out. **Pack light layers and rain shells.**

Decide before you board. Run the [drink-calculator](#) on real drinking patterns, the [budget-calculator](#) for the family total, and the [tipping-calculator](#) for Service Charge + cash tips — MSC mid-sail upgrades cost more per day.

Getting to the ship — and getting home

Arrival: Friday recommended, Saturday required

Friday, December 4 — fly in. Same-day flights to an afternoon all-aboard are risky, and December adds front-driven delays across the eastern seaboard. Pre-cruise hotel in Brickell, Downtown Miami, or Miami Beach.

Saturday, December 5 — embarkation.

- **Terminal: MSC Miami Cruise Terminal** at PortMiami — the MSC-built terminal opened April 2025. *Different from where Royal Caribbean and Carnival board.* Verify the address in the MSC for Me app.
- **MIA → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$30–45, 20–30 min. Taxi flat-rate \$32.
- **FLL → MSC Terminal:** Uber/Lyft \$60–90, 45–60 min.
- **If driving:** Terminal garage ran **\$35/day** (~\$245/week, firsthand May 2026 — verify); offsite lots \$7–14/day with shuttle — weigh the shuttle against a family's bag pile.
- **Embark window:** 11:30 AM – 3:30 PM. Published departure ~4:30 PM; be aboard with an hour's margin — more with kids.
- **Online check-in via MSC for Me** for every passenger — done at home beats a 20-minute queue with children.

Day 8 debark and the trip home

- **The night before:** bags in the hall by ~11 PM with the color-coded tag — or self-carry everything and walk off in the first wave (with kids, seriously consider it).
- **6:00 – 8:00 AM:** Breakfast at Il Mercato or La Brasserie.
- **~7:00 AM:** Arrival + customs clearance. Self-disembarkation begins.
- **7:30 – 10:00 AM:** Walk-off in waves. All passengers off by 10:00 AM.

Carry-on on debark morning: change of clothes per person, all medications, passports, chargers, valuables.

PortMiami → MIA: Uber/Lyft **\$30–45, 25–30 minutes**; pre-book against Saturday surge. Domestic flight after 4 PM → leave the port by 1:30 PM; MIA TSA runs 30–60 min in the Saturday return rush.

Killing hours before an evening flight: Bayfront Park / Bayside Marketplace (10-min walk) · Pérez Art Museum (\$20, air-conditioned) · Brickell by short Uber.

Areas of interest during the cruise

On the ship — World America spots worth knowing

- **The World Promenade** (Deck 8 aft) — seven-deck outdoor walkway around the Y-shaped stern. Signature space; December evenings up here want a light layer.
- **The World Galleria** (Decks 6–8 mid-ship) — three-deck LED-ceiling atrium. **The family meeting point:** “if we’re separated — Galleria, Deck 6, on the hour.”
- **Venom Drop @ The Spiral** — 11-deck dry slide; longest at sea. First hour after opening (typically 10 AM) has the shortest line.
- **Doremiland Kids Clubs / The Harbour** — included; register Day 1 when lines are shortest. Port days run longer morning sessions.
- **Aurea Spa thermal suite** — sea-day intro rates; ~90 minutes is the right dose.
- **La Brasserie** (Deck 19) — 24/7 French-style casual; the calm breakfast.
- **Luna Park Pizza & Burger** (Deck 6) — the reliable kid-dinner fallback, included.

Sea-day priorities (Day 2 + Day 6)

1. **Sunrise coffee at the World Promenade** — kids still asleep, wake unfolding below.
2. **Venom Drop first thing** — empty in the first hour.
3. **Kids-club morning session** — and the quiet hour it buys.
4. **Eataly at lunch** if dinner is booked out.
5. **Port talk for tomorrow’s destination** — the Roatán one especially (weather + logistics).

Specialty dining picks

- **Eataly** (Deck 8) — first Eataly at sea; the one specialty venue that genuinely works for kids. **Book on Day 1.**
- **Kaito Teppanyaki** — the showy hibachi room; a family-dinner win.
- **Paxos** (Deck 8) — Greek seafood on the Promenade.
- **Butcher’s Cut** — steakhouse, for the grown-ups’ night.

Port-day picks (one each)

- **Roatán** — West Bay Beach via taxi (\$6–10/person each way), reef 30 yds offshore. Backup: Gumbalimba Park (monkeys + zipline) if rain reshapes the day.
- **Costa Maya** — the pool complex inside the gated port, free with cruise cards; five minutes from re-boarding for nap runs.
- **Cozumel** — Chankanaab Beach Adventure Park (~\$50) for kid-calm snorkeling; Palancar (~\$50 indep) for confident swimmers on a calm day.
- **Ocean Cay** — **Seakers Family Cove** first (protected shallow zones); Beach Shack lunch 11–4; Marine Conservation Center free tour — the best half-hour of ocean stewardship the kids will get all week.

The lighthouse show at Ocean Cay

Runs only on overnight or late-departure calls — and this sailing’s published window (7 AM – 6 PM) is a daytime call, so the full show most likely does not run. Verify in the app once aboard; if MSC extends the call, Lighthouse Bay is the seating area. Tell the kids the honest version before they see it on a poster.

Photo spots worth knowing

- **World Promenade Deck 8 aft sailaway** — wake beneath the Y-stern, downtown Miami fading in December’s early dusk.
- **The Galleria LED ceiling** — scene changes through the day.
- **Roatán West Bay Beach** — white sand, turquoise, reef offshore (rain-washed light can be the best of the week).
- **Ocean Cay striped lighthouse** at golden hour — Lighthouse Bay beach has the angle.
- **Gala night, everyone dressed** — the Photo Package earns its keep here.

Need an at-home emergency handoff card? Separate one-page doc in the voyage-packs folder. The full Voyage Pack is the unabridged companion document. Soli Deo Gloria.